'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Fall 2021

President's Message

by Jason Geno

Dear Neighbors,

Well, this is my last article as board member and President of CMA. Although more than half of my time as a board member (this go around) has been during a Pandemic, I am very proud of how this board has worked together.

While writing this message, I began to reflect on a word we all use a lot – "COMMUNITY." We throw this word out there in our personal and work lives, but, I thought it was important to illustrate one definition of the word. One meaning is "a feeling of fellowship with others, as a result of sharing common attitudes, interests, and goals." I believe CMA is a community that is constantly evolving and we should continue to plan and execute on initiatives at CMA with the definition above in mind. It is not one board member, or even multiple board members, who make things happen.

Our committee members and the chairs of the committees are certainly neighbors who demonstrate a sense of community. They work tirelessly to make our Association a better place. Without their spirit of community, we would certainly be far behind in our initiatives.

Please remember from our recent annual meeting, there is much to be done to ensure that our infrastructure supports our growing and changing community. Soon we will be welcoming our new board members, but this does not mean we should put the weight of our challenges on the board alone. Our common interests should help us forge working relationships to enable our initiatives to be completed

Let us continue to enhance CMA by "Moving Forward TOGETHER".

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	Tuesday, October 19, 6:30 pm	Teleconference
CMA Committee Meetings	TBD in November	Date/Time set by Committee
Board of Directors Meeting	December 11, 10:00 am	Teleconference
Board of Directors Meeting	January 2022, Date/Time TBD	CMA Office or Barn
CMA Committee Meetings	February 2022	Date/Time set by Committee

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour

October 23-24, 2021
10:00 am - 5:00 pm



Berkeley Springs is home to many fine artists, some of regional and national renown. One of the great fall festivals in Morgan County is the self-guided Berkeley Springs Studio Tour. You can visit local artists in their studios and see how they produce some of their products. You will find contemporary and traditional art and fine crafts in many different media available for sale.

There are 8 studios with 10 artists participating this year. Did you know that several tour artists reside right here in CMA! Rosemary Bigelow's studio, My Grandmother's Lace [Tour Stop K, La Verdad, 5 Mountainside Rd, interior furnishings] is the only CMA studio participating this year. On her outside deck, she'll be hosting fellow CMA artist, Andy Zuckerman, and his line of whimsical birdhouses (Cool Dad's Creatures). She will also be hosting wood worker, Chris Bosley, in the gazebo. We look forward to homeowners Richard Kaufman and Craig Deane returning to the tour next year.

A great place to start is tour headquarters at the Berkeley Springs Ice House Gallery. Docents will provide tour information and maps and you can see samples of many of the participants' work.

For the safety and well being of all, we ask all visitors to please wear a face mask and respect social distancing when visiting each studio. We also ask that only vaccinated individuals participate in this year's tour. Rosemary would be happy to make an appointment for a private showing if you feel uncomfortable when others are around.

For more information check out the tour website at berkeleyspringsstudiotour.org where you will find detailed directions, maps, artist information, and COVID Guidelines. Follow us on the Berkeley Springs Studio Tour Facebook page or call Rosemary Bigelow at 240-675-3930 if you have questions.

Here's what you need to know to plan your trip!

- The Berkeley Springs Studio Tour weekend is October 23-24, 2021 from 10 am to 5 pm
- There are 8 studios at 6 locations with 10 artists showcasing their work
- Start your tour from the Berkeley Springs Ice House at the corner of Independence and Mercer Streets or download the map from the BSST website for a self guided tour.

Is Your Septic Tank Dead?

by Eric Lienhard, G-5

Does your home in Coolfont sit unoccupied for extended periods of time? If so, your septic tank might not be working as efficiently as it should, sending untreated or partially treated wastewater to our lagoons.

So, what's happening? The enzyme and bacteria biosphere inside the septic tank begins to break down without new "food" being introduced from household toilets and drains, causing it to process waste less efficiently. When the bugs run out of food, they begin to die off, and when the last one dies so does the aerobic treatment process. When you return to your house, all the new waste you introduce to the system simply passes through untreated and out to the lagoon.

You might wonder, "what about newly installed systems, there are no bugs in the water yet. Doesn't it just pass through and go out into the lagoon?" It doesn't, but because the water in a new system is clean and fresh, it's not full of toxic, dead organisms that have already been processed as far as they can go. Additionally, your tank has capacity - and time - to build up an efficient bacteria colony to treat the waste being sent to the tank.

What can you do to keep the "Bug Life" in your septic tank vigorous and active?

- Use the house more frequently! Invite guests! Not too many to cause too much food and waste to enter the tank. Bugs can eat only so much, so fast!
- If the house sits for more than 10 days without "food," flush a bacteria colony down your toilet to stimulate existing bacteria upon your return. (Found on Amazon)
- Gone for a month? Flush a cup of sugar and a cup of corn meal before you lock up and leave, giving your existing colony added food to survive on for the month.
- Gone for three months or more? Consider getting your septic tank pumped before you return, giving you added empty volume and time to rebuild your colony of bacteria.

North Pumphouse Updates



The north pumphouse, located at 343 Bobcat Drive, was spruced up a bit this summer. Contractors installed a new metal roof, fascia boards, and gutters. The new gutters and downspouts will route water away from the front of the building, reducing issues with ice on the walk and in front of the door. Later this year, a generator will be installed to provide back up power when needed.



New Playground!

New playground equipment was installed in the play area near the pool and office.



Cacapon Resort State Park Foundation Happenings!

Bark Park to Open Soon

The Cacapon Resort State Park Foundation is putting the finishing touches on their new Bark Park. The Bark Park will have two separate areas for your four-legged friends to run around. The double gate system for the two areas are complete and the exercise areas will be fully enclosed. To get to the dog park, follow signs to the Batt Shelter.





Bark Park still under wraps – opening soon!

Mountain Biking – Rock & Roll

Cacapon State Park is quickly becoming one of the premier mountain biking destinations on the east coast. The Park is home to over 25 miles of mountain bike trails of all styles, with an additional 30 miles planned. In 2020, the International Mountain Bicycling Association (IMBA) presented the park with the Trail Accelerator Award.



The first ever Cacapon Rock and Roll race presented by the National Interscholastic Cycling Association (NICA) happened September 24th and 25th. It was a fun-filled, super positive weekend of middle and high school ages kids racing on the newly completed 2.2-mile course.

Commemorative Bench Project

If you are interested in making a lasting impression on the park, you can purchase a commemorative bench at Cacapon. Benches will be 4-foot long, eco-friendly construction made from recycled plastic that bears don't like to nibble on. A solid bronze plaque with mutually agreed upon wording, will be affixed to each bench. Those words, your memories, the bench and the plaque will remain in your selected spot at Cacapon for decades. The cost is $1,500, complete (bench, plaque, and installation). For more information, visit the Foundation's website.



Note: CMA neighbors are working to organize a bench donation on behalf of CMA owners. Watch the Google Group for details.

Entrance Clean up

In early September, volunteers tackled some clean up work at the CMA entrance from CRVRoad. They removed several dead trees - including two from the pond. The overgrown grasses around the wooden sign were trimmed back and volunteers took the extras to transplant in other areas. Big thanks to the Moore family - owners of the property and adjacent Manor House - for their cooperation and permission.

Before



After



Bonnie Blue Biscuit

by Myrna Wohl, E-4



Ron and I just discovered Bonnie Blue Biscuit at 334 West Boscawen Street in Winchester. It's a great restaurant for breakfast but also has an extensive menu for lunch and dinner which features Texas barbecue and fried oysters. Converted from an old gas station, this restaurant is "eat-in" but we sat on the big outdoor deck. Known for their pies, cakes, muffins, and biscuits that are made from scratch, the place is famous to the locals. Since there were few people there, we stayed for about two hours. The wait staff was so nice. When we were leaving, they asked if we wanted fresh coffee or ice water to take along. Everything was delicious and when we asked to pay for an extra biscuit they said, "No charge. We have tons of them!" The location is near the hospital and is on the corner of two streets that veer off in different directions. If you are looking for a great place to eat that is not elegant but is very "cool" try this cute little place.

The Peobody's (S-5) "recycled" the extra grasses from the entrance clean up.

Iris Melton (K-12) also relocated several grasses to her property.



Water/Sewer Information

Warm Springs Public Service District

Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm:
304-258-4118

All other times Morgan County non-emergency: 304-258-0305

Provide your name, address, lot number, and the nature of the issue.

Fungus Among Us

Mushroom hunting is a popular fall activitiy in forested areas. While hunters are looking for edibles - there is great beauty in the sizes, shapes, and colors of **all** these amazing organisms. Photos courtesy of various CMA owners.



Note: These are not edibles - noted here for their beauty only. If foraging for mushrooms, please be respectful of owners' property and do not enter without prior permission from the owner.

CMA 2022 Budget

Members approved the CMA 2022 budget. The Budget reflects a lower contribution to Water/Sewer and additional funding to Reserves above the 2020 Reserve Study recommendation.

2022 Assessments: $1,250 per property

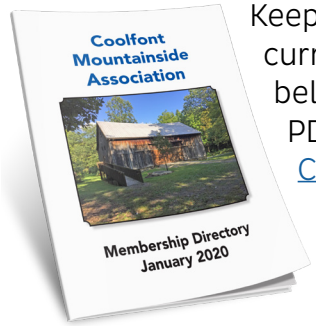
CMA 2022 Budget	
Income	
310 House Assessment	$148,750
320 Lot Assessment	$33,750
360 Late Fees	$650
370 Interest	$1,500
380 Misc Income	$200
390 Rent	$1,200
400 Rental Pool Use Fee	$0
Total Income	**$186,050**
Expense	
410 Pool Operations	$3,500
430 Pool Supplies	$5,000
435 Pool Maintenance	$3,000
440 CPO & Pool Attendants	$9,000
445 Funding to CMA W&S	$35,000
450 Office-Showers Maintenance	$400
520 Road Maintenance	$2,500
530 Road Supplies	$2,500
540 Snow Removal	$6,000
550 Storm Water System Maintenance	$8,000
560 Forest Maintenance	$2,500
630 Barn Maintenance	$1,000
640 Gateway Maintenance	$4,000
645 Mail Center Maintenance	$1,700
670 Recreation Maintenance	$1,500
710 Communications Committee	$750
711 Technology Committee	$500
720 Social Committee	$2,000
721 Welcome Committee	$200
725 Infrastructure Mapping Comm.	$500
730 Firewise Committee	$150
750 Misc Operation	$200
760 Association Business	$500
761 Memberships	$200
762 Payment Processing Fees	$2,000
765 Site Manager	$20,000
780 Bookkeeper	$4,100
790 Legal Fees	$5,000
810 Telephone	$1,000
820 Postage	$500
830 Electric	$2,500
840 Neighborhood Watch Committee	$1,600
850 Insurance Property & Liability	$3,600
855 Insurance Umbrella Policy	$650
860 Bad Debt	$200
880 Taxes (RE Assessments)	$5,600
950 Capital Cash Reserve	$48,700
Total Expense	**$186,050**
Net Income (Loss)	**$0**

2022 Projected Reserve Expenses - CMA	
1600 Barn Structural Repairs	$14,280
6500 Furniture & Pool Equipment	$4,284
6800 Pool Finishes, Plaster	$27,581

Water & Sewer 2022 Budget	
Income	
305 Water Usage Fee	$83,530
315 Sewer Usage Fee	$24,910
325 Late Fee for Water Usage	$1,670
335 Late Fee for Sewer Usage	$500
340 Income-Other	$0
399 Funding from CMA	$35,000
Total Income	**$145,610**
Expense	
415 Water System Labor	$64,000
420 Water System Labor - Other	$12,000
425 Water System Supplies	$7,250
430 Water System Administration	$500
445 Chemicals & Testing Water	$1,750
446 Chemicals & Testing Sewer	$500
470 Permits & Fees	$140
515 Sewer System Labor	$9,300
517 Sewer System Labor - Other	$2,000
525 Sewer System Supplies	$4,000
602 Bookkeeping	$7,800
605 Assoc. Business Fees	$2,500
625 Mileage	$500
635 Miscellaneous Expenses	$200
645 Occupancy Rent to CMA	$1,200
705 Electricity	
Water Electric	$7,000
Sewer Electric	$2,000
715 Postage	$170
725 Telephone	$1,000
735 Legal Expenses	$2,800
800 Fund Account Payments	
801 Repair & Replacement Fund	$3,170
803 Capital Improvement Fund	$15,830
Total Expense	**$145,610**
Net Income (Loss)	**$0**

2022 Projected Reserve Expenses - Water & Sewer	
Signal Wire: S. Pump House to Reservoir	$15,000

Directory Updates



Keep your Membership Directory current with the updates noted below. We will also update the PDF available on the CMA website.

It's been busy since August with many new faces in Coolfont!

C-5 Michele Hewitt
(215) 478-5784 michelehewitt1028@gmail.com
Barry Hewitt
(215) 478-5785 barryhewitt65@gmail.com

E-7 Tom Perez Blue Spruce
(202) 631-2394 perezte21@gmail.com
Ann Marie Staudenmaier
(301) 980-6693 annmarie@legalclinic.org
Part time Rental

G-2 Connor Mazolewski
(949) 330.0745 connormaz14@gmail.com
Part time Rental

K-3 Yuri Soares
(703) 402-2515 soaresyu@yahoo.com
Marina Farias
(202) 841-0061 marinasfarias@yahoo.com
Part time Residents

P-5 Ozlem Arslan Dreamtime
(703) 708-4749 ozlemrslan@gmail.com
Betul Yusufhanoglu
(703) 473-6325 mylivingcolor@hotmail.com
Part time Rental

Q-5 George Drasal Treehouse
(443) 802-5647 georgedrasal@gmail.com
Shelley Drasal
(443) 802-5645 shelleydrasal@gmail.com
Part time Residents

T-7 John White (Lot)
(443) 333-7759 jcwhit4@gmail.com
Erin White
(443) 333-7721 erinslens82@gmail.com

WVHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2021 MEMBER

Board Shorts

August 28 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of June 12 Board Meeting
- Approved invoice for tree work for $287.50
- Approved contracts with BTM CPAs for bookkeeping services for 2022
- Approved proposed 2022 budget to go forward to membership for vote
- Approved DACC revised guidelines to go forward to membership for vote
- Approved WSPSD invoice for $805.00
- Approved purchase/installation of new playground equipment
- Denied owner request for extended septic maintenance interval

September 25 Annual Membership Meeting

- Approved minutes from 2020 Annual Meeting
- Approved 2022 Budget
- Approved changes to Articles of Incorporation
- Approved revised DACC Guidelines
- Elected members to 4 positions on the board

The next Board Meeting is Tuesday, October 19 at 6:30 pm via teleconference.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors

coolfont.board@gmail.com
Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Eric Lienhard, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website

www.coolfontmountainside.org

Google Group Email

cma-members@googlegroups.com

Google Group Signup/Web

groups.google.com/g/cma-members

Facebook

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Manager - Holly Malcomb, AHPMgmt
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jefferson Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Heidi Splane
610-742-5774 heidianderic@comcast.net

Infrastructure Mapping - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Neighborhood Watch - Steve Katz
304-258-9329 skatz844@aol.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406